ZHASSULAN SERIKULY

Senior Software Engineer

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Open to relocation (visa sponsorship required) | Available immediately

SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 6+ years of commercial experience architecting, scaling, and delivering 100+ high-performance web applications and data-intensive platforms across enterprise software, fintech, e-commerce, and digital-twin platforms, serving 1M+ users. Proven track record in technical leadership, mentoring teams of up to 18 engineers, and owning the full SDLC. Focused on web performance (Core Web Vitals), accessibility (WCAG AA), and testing.

Deep full-stack expertise: React, Next.js, and TypeScript on the frontend; Node.js, NestJS, PostgreSQL, and MongoDB on the backend. Built LLM-powered (RAG) features and adopted AI-assisted development workflows with Cursor, Claude Code, and GitHub Copilot, automating quality gates and repetitive engineering tasks to cut time-to-market by ~2x.

HIGHLIGHTS

- Designed a multi-layer caching and invalidation strategy across **10+ platforms**, cutting redundant **API traffic by 50%** and reducing cloud infrastructure **costs by an estimated 20%**.
- **Created shared frontend engineering standards** for code reviews and component architecture, **adopted across 2 companies and 100+ production projects**, shortening onboarding for new engineers by 40%.

EXPERIENCE

CIKLUM - Senior Software Engineer | *Bucharest, Romania (Remote)* | *Aug 2025 - Sep 2026*
UK-based digital product and enterprise software engineering company.

- **Architecture:** Designed React/Next.js and NestJS architecture across 10+ modules, building shared UI components with strict TypeScript and WCAG AA compliance and type-safe REST/GraphQL APIs, cutting feature implementation time by ~30%.
- **Web Performance:** Profiled and optimized rendering, hydration, and interaction-heavy flows across high-traffic modules serving 1M+ users, reducing Interaction to Next Paint (INP) from ~280ms to ~150ms.
- **Technical Leadership & Reliability:** Led frontend architecture and sprint planning for a 6-engineer team, reviewed ~15 GitLab MRs/week, and helped cut post-merge defects by 35%; expanded automated testing with CI/CD gates and Sentry monitoring.
- **Frontend Modernization:** Migrated React/Next.js from Pages Router to App Router (Server Components) and from JavaScript to strict TypeScript; introduced FSD and TanStack Query to standardize architecture and reduce duplicated data fetching.
- **AI Integration & Tooling:** Built LLM-powered product features using RAG with NestJS backend services; also integrated Cursor, Claude Code, and GitHub Copilot into team-wide engineering workflows, cutting time spent on repetitive tasks by nearly half.

KEYHORSE - Middle > Senior > Team Lead Software Engineer | *Almaty, Kazakhstan* | *Jul 2021 - Aug 2025*
GIS and digital-twin platform company serving Central Asia

- **Engineering Leadership:** Led 18 engineers across 3 teams, setting technical direction for 80+ large-scale regional GIS platforms and 100+ smaller digital-twin deployments serving 1.5M+ users across 4 countries.
- **Delivery & Process:** Independently architected and launched 10 enterprise platforms within 1.5 months each (~2x faster than average); introduced Scrum, shared planning, estimation, code review, and documentation, reducing onboarding time by 40%.
- **Frontend & GIS:** Built a shared React architecture using FSD with 100+ reusable Storybook components; optimized Mapbox GL JS and Elasticsearch across 500K+ geo-objects, cutting render time from 800ms to 480ms and search latency by 30%.
- **Backend & Systems:** Built 35+ Node.js/NestJS REST APIs with PostgreSQL, MongoDB, and Redis, containerized with Docker; generated OpenAPI clients and migrated GIS processing to Kafka workers with retries, idempotency, and WebSocket updates.
- **Quality & Observability:** Set up shared testing with Vitest, Playwright, and Cypress across 86 repositories, with automated checks through GitLab CI/CD. Used Grafana dashboards and alerts to monitor production after deployment.

Earlier Experience

- **Independent Contractor - Full-stack Software Engineer** *(2019-2025, alongside full-time roles)* - Delivered 40+ React/Angular/Vue and Node.js applications for international SaaS and e-commerce clients, owning the full SDLC.
- **DAR - Software Engineer** *(Jun 2020 - Jul 2021)* - Delivered ~20 React/Vue web and 5+ mobile apps (Ionic, React Native) across 3-4 parallel projects; shipped food-delivery and booking platforms solo (~200 restaurants, 1,000+ listings) in ~1 month each; cut load times by up to 40%; built FastAPI/MySQL backends for 6 apps, owning REST API design and database schemas.
- **EPAM Systems - Software Engineer** *(Jan 2020 - Jun 2020)* - Built React/TypeScript features across 5+ applications, resolved production issues, and wrote automated tests; selected as 1 of 3 engineers from 40+ candidates.

SKILLS

Frontend: React, Next.js, Angular, Vue, Nuxt.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, Zustand, Redux, Pinia, TanStack Query, FSD, Tailwind, SCSS
AI, Mobile & Quality: LLMs, AI-Assisted Development, React Native, Ionic, Capacitor, Core Web Vitals, WCAG, Agile/Scrum, SDLC
Testing & DevOps: Jest, Vitest, Cypress, Playwright, CI/CD, Git, Docker, Kubernetes, Azure DevOps, Webpack, Vite, Sentry
Backend & APIs: Python, FastAPI, Node.js, NestJS, Express, REST APIs, GraphQL, WebSockets, Microservices, DDD, RBAC
Data & Cloud: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch, Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS, Azure, GCP, Terraform

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

Education: B.Sc. in Information Systems - Suleyman Demirel University (SDU), 2022
Certifications: IELTS Academic 7.0 (C1 Equivalent, 2023) | Professional Recommendation Letter Available
Languages: English (Full Professional) | Kazakh, Russian (Native) | Turkish (Professional Working/B2) | Chinese (Elementary/A2)